Texas State Capitol, Austin



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> One star on the flag. Many stories behind it.

LUTHERAN GRAMMAR SCHOOL

Texas

The Lone Star State. A place, its people, and one hard question.

Maxim Hrehor
Lutheran Grammar School of J.A. Comenius · Kvinta

Shackelford County Courthouse, Albany



Carol M. Highsmith · public domain · Wikimedia Commons

> **Only Alaska covers more ground.**

GEOGRAPHIC ORIENTATION

Texas at a glance

2nd
largest state, after Alaska

Austin
the capital

30 million+
people, and still growing

Caddo Lake



Maciej Kraus · CC BY 2.0 · Wikimedia Commons

> The east gets the rain the west never sees.

PHYSICAL GEOGRAPHY

Rain, pines, and the Gulf

The wet east

Pine woods and the Gulf coast get the most rain. Summers are hot and humid. Hurricanes can reach the shore.

Texas Hill Country, near Medina



Lorenzo The Snail · CC BY-SA 4.0 · Wikimedia Commons

> **The Hill Country rolls. It does not lie flat.**

PHYSICAL GEOGRAPHY

Rivers and rolling land

Hills and plains

The Hill Country sits between rivers and open plains. Winters are usually mild. Storms and a sudden cold can still arrive.

PHYSICAL GEOGRAPHY

Desert, canyons, little water

Big Bend National Park



Martin Proll · public domain · Wikimedia Commons

The dry west

Big Bend holds desert, canyons, and mountains. Days are very hot. Nights can be cold, and water is scarce.

> Out here, water is the real border.

The Alamo, San Antonio



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A republic in 1836. A state in 1845.

HISTORY

How Texas became Texas

First nations
Caddo, Comanche, and Apache peoples lived here for centuries.

Spain and Mexico
Missions came first. Later, Texas was part of Mexico.

1836
Texas became an independent republic.

1845
It joined the United States as the 28th state.

1901
Oil at Spindletop changed the towns and the jobs.

Mission San José, San Antonio



Ashland Thomas · CC BY-SA 4.0 · Wikimedia Commons

> **The Lone Star is a symbol, not the whole people.**

CULTURAL IDENTITY

Many stories, one star

More than one people

Many nations knew this land before any flag. Spanish and Mexican families built towns and a Tejano culture that is still here. Later came Anglo settlers, African Americans, Czechs, and Germans. The **Lone Star** is one symbol, not the whole story.

Roscoe Wind Farm



Matthew T Rader · CC BY-SA 4.0 · Wikimedia Commons

> Oil under the ground. Wind above it.

ECONOMY

Oil, gas, and the wind

Energy

Texas produces oil and natural gas. It also leads the United States in wind power. That strength comes with a duty to use it carefully.

Texas Longhorn



U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service · public domain · Wikimedia Commons

> A ranch and a space center share one state.

ECONOMY

Cities, ports, and ranches

Cities of ideas

Austin builds technology. Houston runs a great port and the Johnson Space Center.

Land and cattle

Cotton and cattle still matter. Ranches keep an older picture of Texas alive.

Downtown Houston



David Daniel Turner · CC BY 4.0 · Wikimedia Commons

> **About two in five Texans are Hispanic or Latino.**

DEMOGRAPHICS AND SOCIETY

A state that keeps growing

Cities and open country

Texas is home to more than 30 million people. Houston, Dallas, San Antonio, and Austin are huge, while much of the land is still ranches and small towns. About two in five residents are Hispanic or Latino. People move here for work, so schools and languages keep changing.

Downtown Austin



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> **In 2021, cold stopped the power.**

A CURRENT CHALLENGE

The week the power stopped

What happened

In February 2021, extreme cold froze equipment. Millions of homes lost heat. Most of the grid is run by ERCOT, not by the national networks.

A fair next step

Some want Texas to stay independent. Others want links to neighboring states. One practical step is to prepare plants and fuel lines for freezing weather.

Texas State Capitol rotunda, Austin



Montysayshello · CC BY-SA 4.0 · Wikimedia Commons

> If it has no source, it is not a fact yet.

EVIDENCE

Where these facts come from

Geography · History · Economy · Society

- U.S. Census Bureau — population and communities
- Texas State Historical Association — the republic, 1845, and Spindletop
- National Weather Service — climate and the February 2021 storm
- ERCOT public reports — how most of the Texas grid is organized

Texas

Marble Falls, Texas Hill Country



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> **Leave me one question.**

LUTHERAN GRAMMAR SCHOOL

Thank you

Ask me one question: a place, a date, or the winter storm.

Maxim Hrehor
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